

YOGA THERAPY

Yoga therapy is a growing field in integrative healthcare, based on the mounting research into yoga's therapeutic benefits. With educational standards and a scope of practice beyond those of yoga teaching, yoga therapists use the tools of yoga to empower individuals toward well-being.

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*Lifestyle changes
and **mindset** shifts
from yoga can
help people move
beyond a disease
focus to cultivate
human flourishing.*

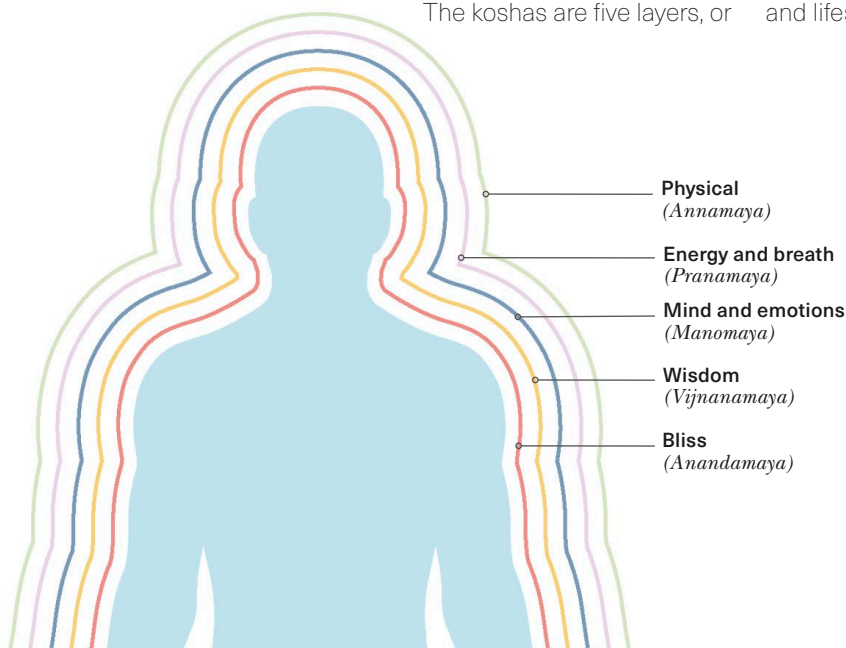
Q WHAT CAN I EXPECT FROM A YOGA THERAPY SESSION?

Yoga therapy sessions are often one-on-one or in small groups of people with similar conditions or life situations. Yoga therapists will always take your health history into account and, though they don't make medical diagnoses, they provide an individualized assessment of your health using tools including:

- **Observations of posture,** movement, and breath
- **Questions about** mood and lifestyle
- **Observations through the lens** of yogic subtle anatomy, such as the *vayus* and the five *koshas*.

The *koshas* are five layers, or

“sheaths,” that make up your self, similar to the layers of an onion. The *koshas* start with your physical well-being and end with bliss (see below). Yoga therapists consider all aspects of your well-being and how they interact in their recommendations. For example, arthritis in your physical body may be affecting your emotions and deeper connection to bliss, while your emotions may be exacerbating the pain. From these observations and considerations, yoga therapists create a personalized plan of care for each client using tools such as poses, breathwork, meditations, and lifestyle suggestions.



THE FIVE KOSHAS

Each of these five layers or “sheaths” must be looked after if we are to live a healthy, balanced life.